

Procurement AI — Progress Report

Period: 22–23 June 2026

Prepared by: Engineering

Audience: Procurement team

Executive summary. In this cycle we (1) merged the separate Subcontractor RFQ tool into the main procurement app so everything lives in one place, (2) made several day-to-day fixes to the RFQ and bid-comparison screens, and (3) built and connected a **new end-to-end bidding and award workflow** that lets vendors submit priced quotations through a secure web link, lets the procurement officer equalize and award **line by line**, and routes the result to the **Procurement Head (Rabia) for final approval**, after which it locks. The new workflow is **built and connected to the live database**. The only remaining piece is the **email automation** (sending vendors their link and emailing Rabia for approval), which sits with the backend/automation operator. Until that is switched on, the links work but must be shared manually.

1. One unified application (Materials + Subcontractor)

The standalone Subcontractor RFQ app has been folded into the main app. You now use a **single system** for both Materials (MR) and Subcontractor (SR) RFQs:

- One sidebar, one dashboard, one RFQ tracker listing both types.
- Subcontractor RFQs keep their own create and detail screens within the same app.
- **No change to the existing Materials flows** — they work exactly as before.

A small clean-up: on the Subcontractor RFQ screen, the **“Frame” tab is renamed “BoQ Upload”**, and the action button is now **“Lock & Build BoQ”** (clearer language for the same step). Once an SR RFQ is **issued**, its Overview details and covering email become **read-only** to prevent accidental edits after dispatch.

Note: the old standalone Subcontractor app can be decommissioned once you’ve confirmed everything works in the unified app.

2. RFQ & vendor screen improvements

- **Vendor tab now shows the real recipients.** Previously, after an RFQ was issued the Vendors tab listed the *entire* matched vendor pool. It now shows **only the vendors actually sent the RFQ** (“Sent to N vendors”), with a **“Show all matched”** toggle for the wider pool. This matches what actually went out and removes confusion. (Drafts still show the full selectable list as before.)

3. Bid comparison improvement

- **Lowest bid is now highlighted in green** instead of the previous pink/crimson. Green reads correctly as “best price”; the old colour looked like a warning.

4. New: deterministic bidding, line-by-line award, and approval

This is the major addition. It replaces error-prone AI reading of emailed quotes with **structured, vendor-entered data**, and adds the award and sign-off steps procurement asked for.

a) Vendors submit quotations via a secure link

- Each invited vendor receives their **own single-use web link**. They open it (no login), see the **material list**, and type their **unit rates, brand/make, quantity offered, and a remark/exclusion per line**, plus commercial terms (payment, lead time, validity, VAT).
- They can leave lines blank (“no quote”), and **revise and re-submit until the deadline**; it then locks.
- On submit, the data lands **directly in the system** and flows straight into the comparison — no manual entry, no AI guesswork.
- **The link is the only way to quote**, which keeps the data clean and comparable.

b) Officer equalization (fair, like-for-like comparison)

- When a vendor’s remark says they **exclude part of the scope** (e.g. “we won’t do X”), the officer can add an **“equalization” value** — a budgeted cost for the missing scope — so that vendor’s line is compared **fairly** against vendors who included it.
- The vendor’s original quote is **never changed**; the equalization is the officer’s judgement, with a required note. Rankings (and the green “lowest”) use the **equalized** figure.

c) Line-by-line award

- The officer awards **each line to a vendor**, defaulting to the lowest equalized price. A 20-line RFQ can be split across several vendors (e.g. 5 lines each to three vendors).
- If a line is **not** awarded to the lowest, a **reason is required**.
- A **split summary** shows each vendor’s awarded lines and totals — the officer’s worksheet for raising POs.

d) Two-step approval (Officer → Procurement Head)

- When ready, the officer clicks **“Submit for approval.”** This generates a **single-use review link for Rabia**.
- Rabia opens the link, sees the **proposed award** (per-line, equalized, with reasons and totals), and either **Approves & locks** or **Returns for revision** with comments.
- On approval, the comparison and awards are **locked at the database level** — no further edits. If returned, the officer sees the comments and can revise and resubmit.

Scope note: raising the actual **Purchase Orders remains a manual step by the officer** for now (PO generation was intentionally left out of this phase). The **Subcontractor (SR) version** of this

bidding/award/approval flow is **planned next** and needs a couple of SR-specific decisions before it's built.

5. Data sanity check (21 June upload — “7 PRs but 5 showed”)

We investigated the report that a material-sheet upload said ~7 PRs but the dashboard appeared to show fewer. **Result: no data was lost.** All 7 PRs from the 21 June upload are correctly stored and visible on the **PR Tracker**. The “fewer” appearance came from the dashboard’s **“Recent RFQs (latest 5)”** widget, which deliberately shows only the 5 newest. Two reminders: the dashboard “PRs tracked” figure is a **running total across all dates**, and **one RFQ can span multiple PRs** (and vice-versa), so RFQ count and PR count are not the same number. *(Optional future tweak: add a “View all” link / “showing 5 of N” label.)*

6. What’s pending (needed before go-live)

Item	Owner	Status
Put the vendor bid link into the dispatch email (link-only)	Automation operator (n8n)	Pending
Vendor confirmation email on submit	Automation operator	Pending
Email Rabia the approval link + notify officer on approve/return	Automation operator	Pending
Turn off the old email→AI quote reading for these RFQs	Automation operator	Pending
Confirm production deployment is live	Hosting (Vercel)	Verify

Until the emails are switched on, the links **work** but the officer must **copy and send them manually** (the app shows the link to copy).

7. How to try it (once deployed/verified)

- Open an issued Materials RFQ with bids → **Compare bids**.
- Use **Per-line award & equalization**: adjust any excluded-scope line, award each line, **Save**.
- **Submit for approval** → copy the review link → open it as “Rabia” → **Approve & lock** or **Return**.
- Vendor experience: open a bid link → fill the material list → **Submit**.

8. Notes for awareness

- The new features are **connected to the live database**; the underlying data tables and rules were added without affecting any existing data or flows.
- A couple of items are flagged for the **backend/IT operator**: the new database objects now exist in the live system, and the database currently runs with broad access settings — worth a security review as the platform grows.

Bottom line. Materials procurement now has a complete digital path from vendor quotation → fair comparison → line-by-line award → Procurement Head approval → locked record, with deterministic data instead of AI extraction. It is built and database-connected; it goes fully self-serve for vendors the moment the email automation is switched on. The Subcontractor version is the next step.